

High School Researcher Interested in Your Molecular Dynamics Work

From: Smyan Reddy <mathlete.world@gmail.com>

To: o.tastanbishop <o.tastanbishop@ru.ac.za>

Date: 7/8/2026, 3:20:59 PM

Dear Professor Taştan Bishop,

My name is Smyan Reddy, and I am a 10th grade student at Lambert High School with a deep interest in computational biology and cancer immunotherapy. I have followed your work at RUBi using molecular dynamics to study drug resistance mechanisms, which directly overlaps with my own computational approach.

It directly connects to independent research I've been conducting at the University of Cape Town on cancer immunotherapy, where I've been performing molecular dynamics simulations.

I am passionate about democratizing research. I serve as Chief Operating Officer at the National Student Research Institution, where I help support research infrastructure across 98+ countries and 16,000+ researchers. I also host the Sustain podcast, which explores health equity and expanding scientific access in low and middle income countries.

I use GROMACS for molecular dynamics simulations, ChimeraX for protein structure modeling, and Python and R with Pandas for data analysis. I have a peer reviewed publication in molecular virology.

I would be incredibly grateful for the opportunity to contribute to RUBi, even in a junior capacity. I am available to work remotely. I understand you receive many requests and I appreciate your time regardless. I have included my resume below.

Warmly,

Smyan Reddy

10th Grade, Lambert High School

Suwanee, GA

mathlete.world@gmail.com

+1 (470) 662-7153

Re: High School Researcher Interested in Your Molecular Dynamics Work

From: Ozlem Tastan Bishop <o.tastanbishop@ru.ac.za>

To: mathlete.world@gmail.com

Date: 7/9/2026, 3:23:56 PM

Dear Syam,

You have an impressive CV!

Unfortunately, I do not have any funding to recruit you. But I will definitely keep you in mind.
Best wishes

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Prof Dr Özlem TASTAN BISHOP

Member of Academy of Science of South Africa (MASSAf)

Fellow of Royal Society of South Africa (FRSSAf)

Director of Research Unit in Bioinformatics (RUBi)

Department of Biochemistry, Microbiology and Bioinformatics

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Re: High School Researcher Interested in Your Molecular Dynamics Work

From: Smyan Reddy <mathlete.world@gmail.com>

To: Ozlem Tastan Bishop <o.tastanbishop@ru.ac.za>

Date: 7/9/2026, 3:27:51 PM

Dear Prof. Tastan Bishop,

Thank you so much for your kind reply and for reviewing my CV. I truly appreciate it, especially coming from your group at RUBi — I have long admired your work in structural bioinformatics and allostery.

I wanted to quickly clarify: I do not require any funding, stipend, or financial support. I am seeking a purely volunteer, remote research experience to learn and contribute.

I am currently doing informal computational work with multiple professors, and I have my own access to GROMACS and Python. I can contribute remotely to tasks such as molecular dynamics setup/analysis, virtual screening, Python scripting for structural analysis, or literature reviews at no cost or administrative burden to your lab.

I am happy to work on a trial basis for 2-3 weeks on a small pilot task if that would be helpful to assess fit.

Thank you again for your consideration. I would be honored to contribute to RUBi in any capacity.

Warm regards,

Smyan Reddy

Lambert High School, Georgia, USA

mathlete.world@gmail.com

+1 (470) 662-7153

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Re: High School Researcher Interested in Your Molecular Dynamics Work

From: Ozlem Tastan Bishop <o.tastanbishop@ru.ac.za>

To: mathlete.world@gmail.com

Date: 7/15/2026, 12:18:01 PM

Dear Smyan,

Many thanks for the clarification, and I sincerely apologize for my silence. It is the start of the third term here, and it has been an incredibly busy time, especially with six new MSc students whom I have been helping to get started on their research projects.

I have so many project ideas in mind that you could contribute to! Please give me a week to design a suitable project, and I will get back to you with some ideas:-)

Best wishes

--



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Re: High School Researcher Interested in Your Molecular Dynamics Work

From: Smyan Reddy <mathlete.world@gmail.com>

To: Ozlem Tastan Bishop <o.tastanbishop@ru.ac.za>

Date: 7/15/2026, 1:55:21 PM

Dear Özlem,

Thank you so much — no need to apologize at all, and congratulations on the start of term! Six new MSc students sounds like a lot to juggle, so I truly appreciate you taking the time to get back to me.

I'm really excited to hear that you have project ideas in mind. I'll look forward to hearing from you in a week!

Warm regards,
Smyan

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Re: High School Researcher Interested in Your Molecular Dynamics Work

From: Ozlem Tastan Bishop <o.tastanbishop@ru.ac.za>

To: Smyan Reddy <mathlete.world@gmail.com>

Date: 7/15/2026, 2:24:47 PM

Dear Smyan,

Just a quick question - Do you have access to high performing computers to run MDs?

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Re: High School Researcher Interested in Your Molecular Dynamics Work

From: Smyan Reddy <mathlete.world@gmail.com>

To: Ozlem Tastan Bishop <o.tastanbishop@ru.ac.za>

Date: 7/15/2026, 2:27:28 PM

Dear Özlem,

Not directly, unfortunately. I'm currently at a summer program at the University of Albany, where I have access to their HPCC, but I'm not certain I can use it beyond the duration of the program. I'm also connected with people at Forschungszentrum Jülich in Germany who work with the JURECA DC supercomputer, though again, that access wouldn't be direct on my end. Being a high schooler does limit what I can independently access.

That said, I'm very eager to find a way to make this work and am open to any suggestions you might have.

Best regards,
Smyan

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